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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 2

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 2 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 2 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (3 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (0 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word. A box left empty gives no letter and is not seen by the check.

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.
- **Drawings.** Pictures of rulers, scales, clocks, coins and notes are original drawings, not to scale unless a page says so. Coins and notes are inspired by Singapore money, drawn larger than real and in black and white.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size).

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S2-01	P2-06	Dollars and Cents	1 star
S2-05	P2-08	Metres	1 star
S2-10	P2-07	Time to the Minute	1 star

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P2-01 to P2-40).

What the booklet covers

Money 1.1 counting amount of money in dollars and cents **S2-01**

Money 1.2 reading and writing money in decimal notation **S2-01**

Length, Mass and Volume 1.1 measuring (length in metres; mass in kilograms/grams; volume of liquid in litres) **S2-05**

Length, Mass and Volume 1.2 using appropriate units of measurement and their abbreviations m, g, kg, ℓ **S2-05**

Time 2.1 telling time to the minute **S2-10**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.2; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.6; Addition and Subtraction 2.1; Addition and Subtraction 2.2; Multiplication and Division 3.1; Multiplication and Division 3.2; Multiplication and Division 3.3; Multiplication and Division 3.4; Multiplication and Division 3.5; Fractions 1.1; Fractions 1.2; Fractions 1.3; Fractions 2.1; Money 1.3; Money 1.4; Length, Mass and Volume 1.3; Time 2.2; Time 2.3; 2D Shapes 1.1; 3D Shapes 2.1; Picture Graphs with Scales 1.1.

S2-01 (P2-06)

Dollars and Cents

★ Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins and notes, decimal notation

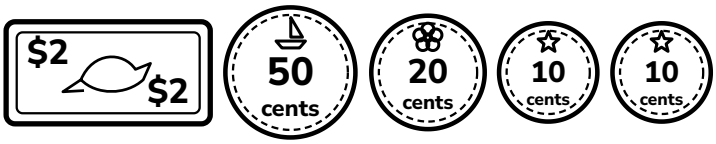
Count the money in each purse.
Write the total, like $3.45.
Use the code table.

1 

$ ____

2 

$ ____

3 

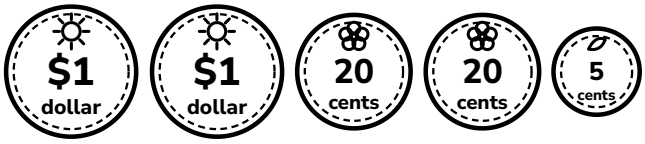
$ ____

4 

$ ____

5 

$ ____

6 

$ ____

Code table

$1.45 = Q	$1.85 = A	$2.45 = R	$2.65 = S	$2.80 = Z
$2.90 = I	$3.40 = V	$3.90 = P	$6.15 = L	$10.25 = O

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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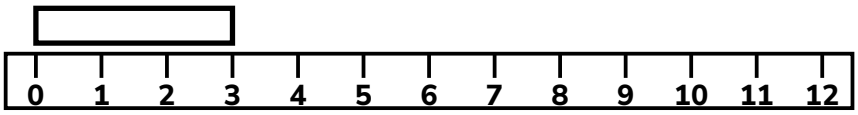
S2-05 (P2-08)

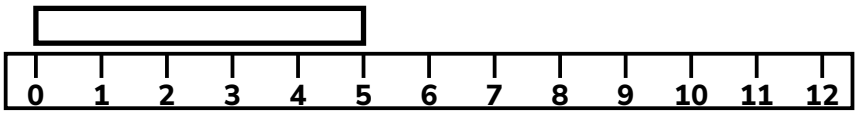
Metres

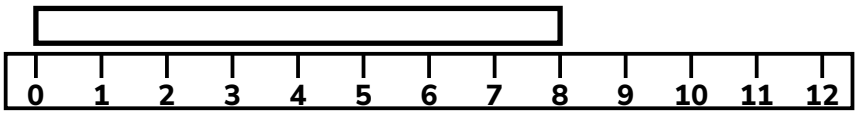
Name _____

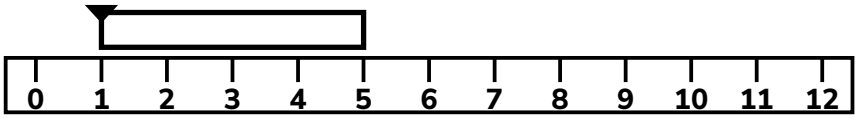
Topic: Length: measuring in metres (m)

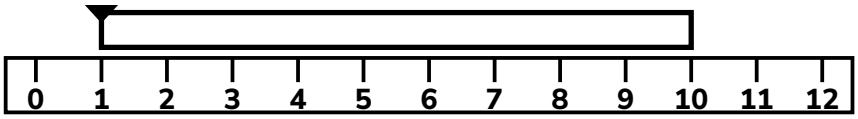
Each tape shows metres.
How long is each thing? Write it in metres.
Use the code table.

1. rope  m

2. wall  m

3. path  m

4. snake  m

5. ribbon  m

Code table

2 = Q	3 = G	4 = N	5 = R	6 = K
7 = Y	8 = U	9 = T	11 = X	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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S2-10 (P2-07)

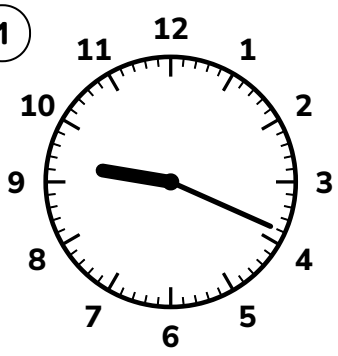
Time to the Minute

Name _____

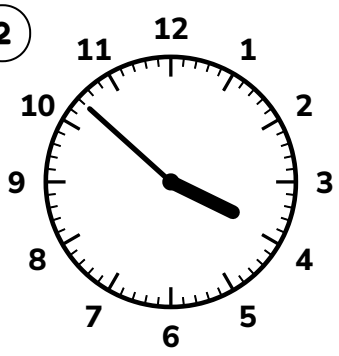
Topic: Time: telling time to the minute

Read each clock.
Write the time, like 3:47.
Use the code table.

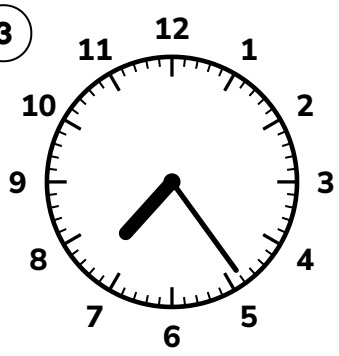
1



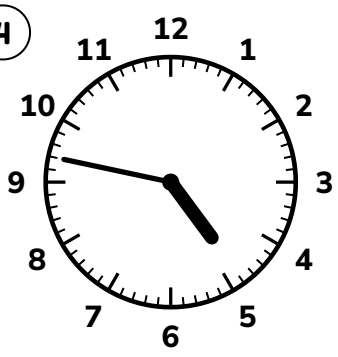
2



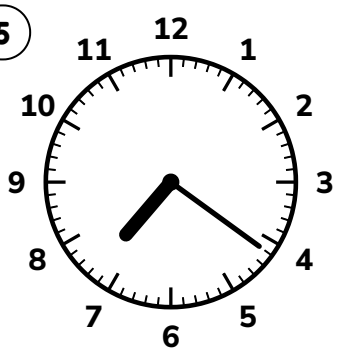
3



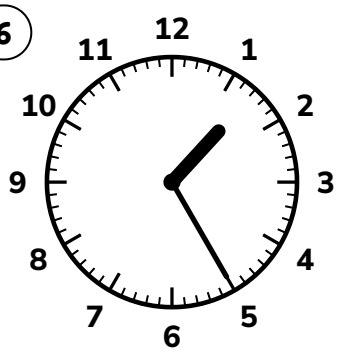
4



5



6



Code table

1:24 = J	1:25 = G	3:52 = T	4:47 = I	6:24 = Z
7:21 = N	7:22 = Y	7:24 = R	7:26 = Q	9:19 = S

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word?

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